THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 3

Chapter 4: **The Colonial Era in India** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which is an example of resistance by a coastal queen? 1

(a) Rani Lakshmibai **(b)** Begum Hazrat Mahal
(c) Rani Abbakka **(d)** Rani Durgavati

2. Which statement best captures the 'drain of wealth'? 1

(a) Free trade
(b) Gifts
(c) Revenue and profits flowing from India without equal return
(d) Gold coming in

3. A village loses its council and gets a distant court. This reflects 1

(a) tradition **(b)** centralisation under colonial rule
(c) democracy **(d)** decentralisation

4. A text calls the Great Famine 'man-made'. The argument is 1

(a) trade **(b)** rain only
(c) god only **(d)** policy failures worsened it

5. A rebel says 'we fight to save our faith and kingdom.' This reflects which cause of 1857? 1

(a) Telegraph **(b)** Religious and political discontent
(c) Tea **(d)** Railway fares

6. Which would NOT be a reason for the Company's success? 1

(a) Disciplined troops **(b)** Strong Indian unity
(c) Naval power **(d)** Rivalries among rulers

7. A British officer writes 'Indians are to be Indian in blood but English in taste'. He supports 1

(a) Gandhi **(b)** Tipu
(c) Macaulay's education aim **(d)** Dalhousie

8. A historian calls 1857 'the First War of Independence', another calls it 'mutiny'. This shows 1

(a) facts never exist **(b)** no rebellion
(c) no sources **(d)** interpretations differ

9. **Assertion (A):** Railways in colonial India mainly served British interests. 1
Reason (R): They were built largely to move raw materials and troops.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** The Dutch were defeated by Travancore at the Battle of Colachel in 1741. 1
Reason (R): The French founded Pondicherry in 1674.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How did 1857 change British policy? 2

12. What does the Colachel victory show? 2

13. What does the tax-in-famine example show about the Company's priorities? 2

14. Why are women like Abbakka and Lakshmibai important to this story? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Evaluate the argument that colonial rule had some unintended benefits. 3

16. Examine why Awadh's annexation angered many. 3

17. Explain the role of the English East India Company's charter in its rise. 3

OR

Case: A famine kills one-third of the population but taxes are still collected. Name the event and comment. 3

18. Interpret: 'Railways were laid with Indian money.' What does it reveal? 3

OR

Assess the effect of the Inquisition on Goa's society. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** Under Albuquerque the Portuguese captured Goa in 1510. They also introduced the cartaz system, under which ships in the Arabian Sea had to buy Portuguese permits or risk seizure. In coastal Karnataka, Rani Abbakka II of Ullal resisted them bravely using fireballs. 5
(i) In which year was Goa captured?
(ii) What was a cartaz?
(iii) Which queen resisted the Portuguese at Ullal?
(iv) Why did the cartaz system benefit the Portuguese?

20. Compare the nature of Portuguese, Dutch, French and British expansion in India. 5

OR

How should historians use records written by colonial officers? Illustrate with the Bengal famine or 1857. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks